

JAHANGIRNAGAR UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF ENGLISH

BA (HONOURS) 4TH YEAR FINAL EXAMINATION QUESTION BANK

COURSE CODE: E 410

COURSE TITLE: Phonetics and Phonology

Target Stream: Concentration on Applied Linguistics & ELT

Batches Included: 42, 43, 44, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50 (Batch 45 missing)

CURRENT SYLLABUS REFERENCE & SCOPE (Session: 2021–2022, Batch 51)

SYLLABUS TOPICS:

- **Foundations:** Phonetics vs. Phonology; Speech production organs; Airstream mechanisms (pulmonic egressive, glottalic, velaric).
- **Phonological Concepts:** Phonemes, phones, and allophones (Trubetzkoy, Jakobson, Daniel Jones, Chomsky, Halle); Minimal pairs and sets.
- **Vowel System:** English monophthongs (classification by tongue height, backness, and lip rounding); Diphthongs and triphthongs; Cardinal vowel chart.
- **Consonant System:** English consonants categorized by place (bilabial, labiodental, dental, alveolar, post-alveolar, palatal, velar, glottal) and manner of articulation (plosives, fricatives, affricates, nasals, liquids/approximants).
- **Syllable Structure:** Phonetic and phonological definitions; Syllable template (Onset, Rhyme: Nucleus/Peak, Coda); Phonotactic constraints and possibilities.
- **Connected Speech:** Strong and weak forms; Contractions; Elision; Assimilation (progressive, regressive, coalescent); Linking.
- **Suprasegmentals:** Stress (nature, acoustic correlates, stress rules on simple/compound words); Stress-timed vs. syllable-timed rhythm; Tone and tone units; Tone sandhi; Intonation and its communicative functions.
- **Transcription:** Broad and narrow IPA transcription of isolated words and connected spoken discourse.

SECTION A: BROAD THEORETICAL QUESTIONS

Comprehensive descriptive and theoretical questions on articulatory phonetics, phonological patterns, and prosody.

Broad Essay Questions

1. How are speech sounds classified in phonetics? Which organs are responsible for initiating the airstream in speech? [50, 49, 47]
2. Explain the classification of English monophthongs according to tongue height, tongue position, and lip rounding, with clear diagrams and examples. [50, 48, 46]
3. Categorize English consonant phonemes according to their places and manners of articulation. Provide an annotated consonant chart. [50, 49, 48, 47, 46]
4. Define the 'syllable'. Discuss the phonotactic possibilities and constraints of English consonants in syllable onset and coda positions with examples. [50, 49, 48, 47, 46]
5. Define tone sandhi and explain its significance in tonal languages with examples. Give an example of tone sandhi in a non-Chinese tonal language. [50]
6. What is intonation? Discuss the main functions of intonation (attitudinal, grammatical, accentual, discourse). How does intonation affect meaning and resolve ambiguity in English sentences? [50, 46]
7. How does the English pronunciation of Bangladeshi EFL learners differ from the standard British (RP) or General American accent? Discuss with specific phonological examples. [50]
8. What is meant by airstream mechanism? Write a detailed account of the state and functions of the varied airstream mechanisms. [49]
9. What are diphthongs? Exhibit the English diphthongs in a vowel diagram, and discuss their phonetic features. Which diphthongs are particularly problematic for Bengali-speaking EFL learners? [49]

10. What is tone? Display the major English tones in diagrams (fall, rise, fall-rise, rise-fall, level), and delineate their semantic behaviours in authentic communication. [49, 46]
11. What is stress? Explain and exemplify the different types and qualities of stress (primary, secondary, unstressed) in the English language. [49, 47]
12. What do you understand by 'connected speech'? Explicate with examples the features of speech production that give rise to connected speech (assimilation, elision, weak forms, linking 'r'). [49, 47]
13. How does phonetics differ from phonology? Write an account of the varied aspects of speech sounds with which phonetics is concerned. [48, 46]
14. How will you prove that English is a stress-timed language? Expound the factors that produce stress prominence in certain syllables. [48, 46]
15. What do you mean by 'tone' and 'tone language'? Is English a tone language? Exemplify the use of tone on one-syllable English utterances. [47]
16. What do you understand by 'manners of articulation'? Elucidate the manners of articulation of vowel and consonant sounds. [47]

SECTION B: SHORT NOTES & CORE CONCEPTS

Short notes and definitions of fundamental articulatory and acoustic concepts.

Short Notes Collection

1. Fricatives [50, 48, 46]
2. Elision [50, 46]
3. English diphthongs (Centring vs. Closing) [50, 48, 46]
4. Phonetics versus Phonology [50, 47]
5. Monophthongs (Pure vowels) [49]
6. Functions of intonation [49]
7. Voiced and voiceless sounds [49]
8. Suprasegmentals (Prosodic features) [49]
9. Plosives (Stops) [48, 46]
10. Approximants (Glides and Liquids) [48, 46]
11. Tone-unit and its structure [48]
12. Stress placement rules on simple words [48]
13. Phonemes, phones, and allophones [48, 47, 46]
14. Minimal pair and minimal set [47]
15. Places of articulation of consonants [47]
16. Assimilation (Regressive, Progressive, Coalescent) [46]
17. Strong and weak form words [46]

SECTION C: PRACTICAL TRANSCRIPTION & PHONETIC EXERCISES

Practical phonetic transcription of natural conversational dialogues and isolated lexical items with stress marking.

IPA Transcription of Connected Spoken Dialogue [50]

Task: Provide an accurate broad IPA transcription of the following conversational exchange, indicating appropriate stress and intonation boundaries:

Elise: "Invite me to dinner, Frank?"

Frank Taylor: "What?" [Elise gives Frank a look]

Frank Taylor: "Would you like to have dinner?"

Elise: "Women don't like questions."

Frank Taylor: "Join me for dinner."

Elise: "Too demanding."

Frank Taylor: "Join me for dinner?"

Elise: "Another question."

Frank Taylor: [thinks for a moment] "I'm having dinner, if you'd care to join me."

[Elise smiles at Frank]

IPA Transcription and Stress Marking (Lexical Callset 1) [49]

Task: Transcribe any **TEN** of the following words into IPA, and assign the primary stress mark [ˈ] on the appropriate syllable:

1. average
2. between
3. condition
4. describe
5. everything
6. following
7. garage
8. hesitate
9. illustrate
10. January
11. knowledge
12. language
13. satisfactory
14. Tuesday
15. wastage

IPA Transcription and Stress Marking (Lexical Callset 2) [48]

Task: Transcribe any **TEN** of the following words into IPA, assigning primary stress marks appropriately:

daily, introduction, produce, destroy, earning, sister, Tuesday, era, ability, July, become, fantastic, responsibility, tomorrow, mango, disaster, amazing, waiting, zero, satisfy.

IPA Transcription of Multi-Syllabic Lexical Items [46]

Task: Transcribe any **SEVEN** of the following words into IPA:

department, examination, introduce, company, discover, system, Wednesday, area, capability, October, between, production, possession, yesterday.